❀ GlowWell

Beauty Clinic Management System

USER GUIDE

Online booking, customer records, staff schedules and reporting

Item	Detail
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Student name	
Student number	

Contents

1. Introduction..... 2
1.1 What the system does..... 2
1.2 User roles..... 2
1.3 Demonstration accounts..... 2
2. Installing and starting the system..... 3
3. Database schema..... 4
3.1 Entity relationship overview..... 4
3.2 Relationships in plain language..... 4
3.3 Table and field definitions..... 4
4. Customer guide..... 8
4.1 Create an account..... 8
4.2 Log in..... 9
4.3 Book an appointment..... 10
4.4 Reschedule a booking..... 13
4.5 Cancel a booking..... 14
4.6 Log out..... 14
5. Administrator guide..... 15
5.1 Dashboard..... 15
5.2 Manage bookings..... 15
5.3 Manage customers..... 18
5.4 Manage staff..... 19
5.5 Staff schedules..... 20
5.6 Manage services..... 21
5.7 Reports..... 22
6. Security and data protection..... 24
7. Messages and troubleshooting..... 25

1. Introduction

GlowWell Beauty Clinic offers facials, massages, hair treatments, wellness and speciality services. Bookings, customer records and staff schedules used to be handled manually, which led to errors, double bookings and poor communication. The GlowWell Management System replaces this with a secure web application that runs in any browser.

1.1 What the system does

- **Customers** register, browse services, book appointments online, reschedule or cancel them, and receive email notifications.
- **Administrators** see a live dashboard, manage bookings, customers, staff, working schedules and services, and generate revenue reports.
- **The system prevents double bookings** automatically: only genuinely free time slots are offered, and the database rejects clashes.

1.2 User roles

Role	Can do	Cannot do
Visitor (not logged in)	View the home page and service list, register, log in	Book or see any personal data
Customer	Book, reschedule and cancel own appointments; view own booking history	See other customers or any admin page
Administrator	Everything in the Admin menu: bookings, customers, staff, schedules, services, reports	Book through the customer screen (uses Admin > Bookings instead)

1.3 Demonstration accounts

The sample database includes these accounts so every feature can be tried immediately:

Role	Email	Password
Administrator	admin@glowwell.co.za	Admin@123
Customer	thandi@example.com (also priya@, sipho@, emma@example.com)	Customer@123

2. Installing and starting the system

The system needs a web server with PHP 8 and MySQL (or MariaDB). A free package such as XAMPP or WAMP provides everything.

1. Start **Apache** and **MySQL** from the XAMPP/WAMP control panel.
2. Unzip the **glowwell** folder into the web server folder (for XAMPP this is htdocs).
3. Open **phpMyAdmin** (http://localhost/phpmyadmin), choose **Import**, select the file **glowwell.sql** from the database folder and click **Go**. This creates the glowwell database, all tables and the sample data.
4. If your MySQL user is not “root” with an empty password, open the file **config/db.php** in a text editor and enter your own MySQL username and password.
5. Open a browser and go to **http://localhost/glowwell/**. The GlowWell home page appears.

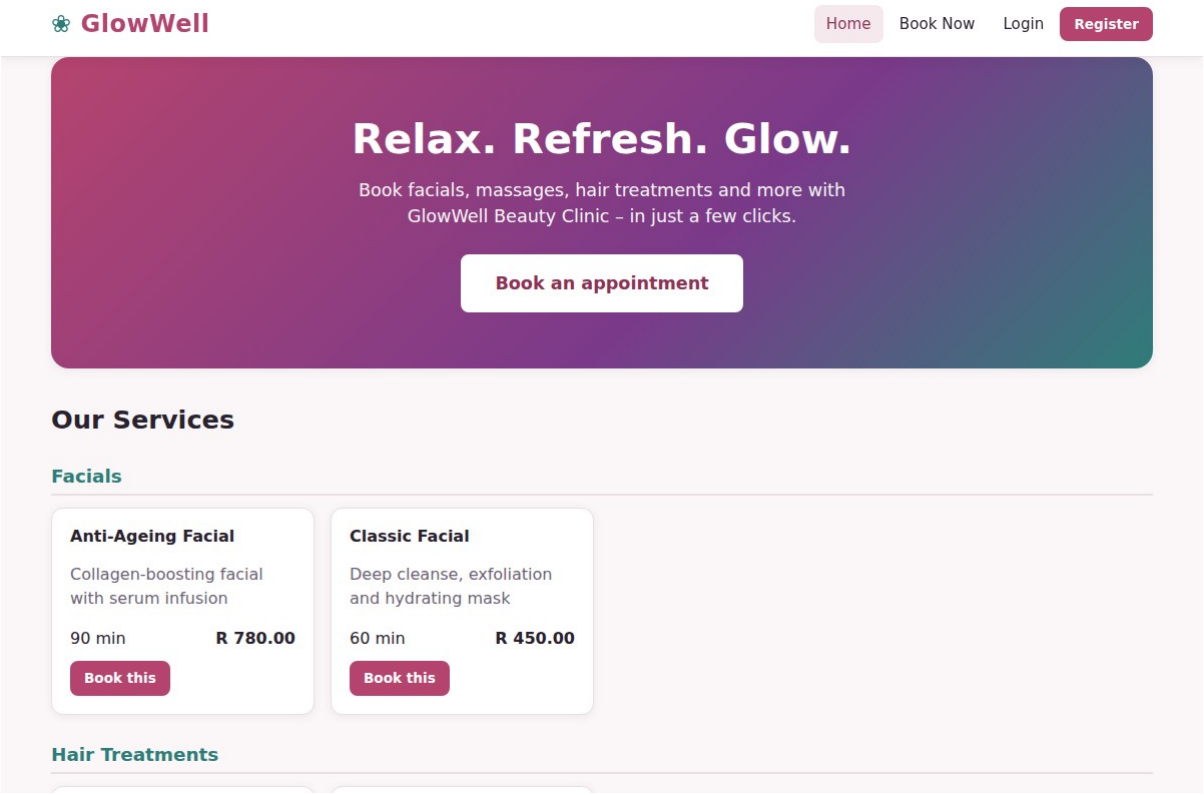


Figure 1: The GlowWell home page with the service list

3. Database schema

The database is called **glowwell** and contains nine related tables. It is normalised to third normal form: each fact is stored once (for example a service's price lives only in services), many-to-many relationships use a link table (staff_services), and repeating groups such as weekly hours have their own table (staff_schedules).

3.1 Entity relationship overview

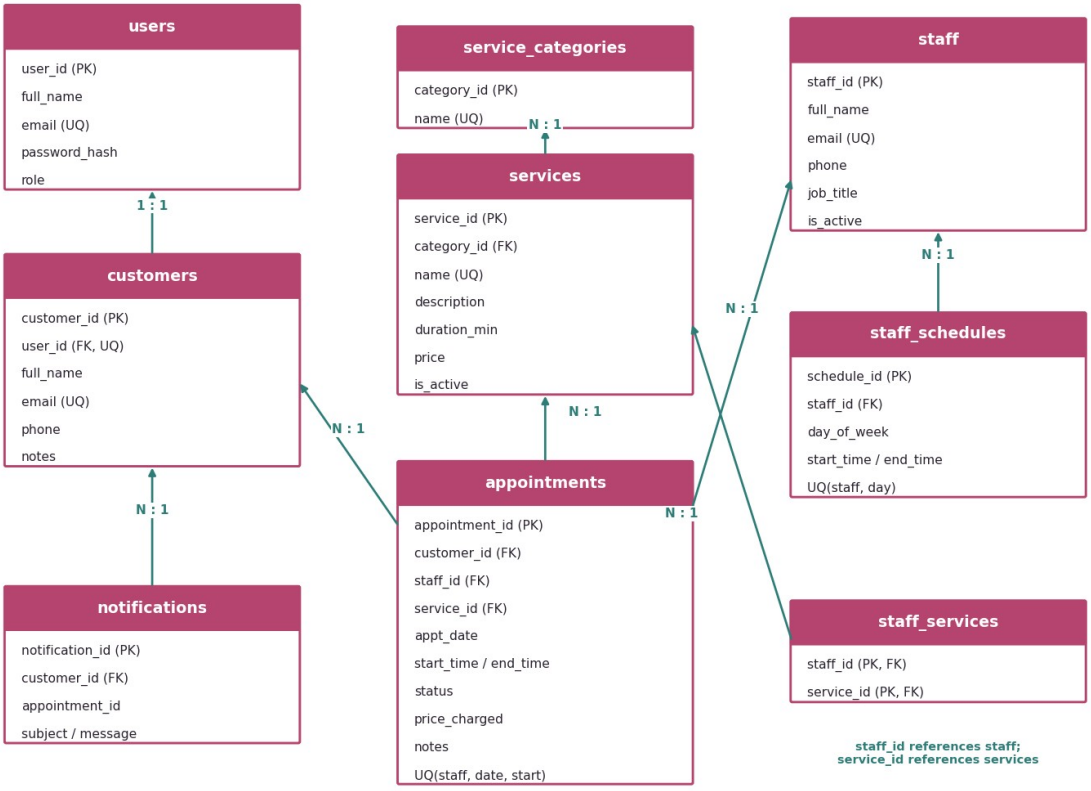


Figure 2: Entity relationship diagram (PK = primary key, FK = foreign key, UQ = unique)

3.2 Relationships in plain language

- One **user** account belongs to at most one **customer** record.
- A **service category** contains many **services**.
- A **staff** member can perform many services, and a service can be performed by many staff (staff_services).
- Each staff member has up to seven **schedule** rows – one per weekday worked.
- An **appointment** links one customer, one staff member and one service. Many appointments can exist for each of them.
- Each **notification** belongs to one customer.

3.3 Table and field definitions

3.3.1 users

Login accounts for administrators and customers. Passwords are stored as secure hashes, never as plain text.

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
user_id	INT UNSIGNED	Primary key, auto-increment	Unique account number
full_name	VARCHAR(100)	Required	Name of the account holder
email	VARCHAR(120)	Required, UNIQUE	Login name; no two accounts may share one
password_hash	VARCHAR(255)	Required	Encrypted (hashed) password
role	ENUM('admin','customer')	Required, default customer	Decides which pages the user can open
created_at	TIMESTAMP	Default current time	When the account was created

3.3.2 customers

Client records. A customer may have an online login (user_id) or be a walk-in captured by an administrator.

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
customer_id	INT UNSIGNED	Primary key, auto-increment	Unique customer number
user_id	INT UNSIGNED	Foreign key to users, UNIQUE, optional	Links to the login account (empty for walk-ins)
full_name	VARCHAR(100)	Required	Customer name
email	VARCHAR(120)	Required, UNIQUE	Contact email and notification address
phone	VARCHAR(20)	Required	10-digit phone number
notes	VARCHAR(255)	Optional	Preferences or special requirements
created_at	TIMESTAMP	Default current time	Date the record was created

3.3.3 service_categories

Groups services (Facials, Massages, Hair Treatments, Wellness, Speciality).

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
category_id	INT UNSIGNED	Primary key, auto-increment	Unique category number
name	VARCHAR(60)	Required, UNIQUE	Category name

3.3.4 services

Treatments offered by the clinic.

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
service_id	INT UNSIGNED	Primary key, auto-increment	Unique service number
category_id	INT UNSIGNED	Foreign key to service_categories	Category the service belongs to
name	VARCHAR(100)	Required, UNIQUE	Service name

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
description	VARCHAR(255)	Optional	Short description shown to customers
duration_min	SMALLINT UNSIGNED	Required	Length of the treatment in minutes
price	DECIMAL(8,2)	Required	Price in Rand
is_active	TINYINT(1)	Default 1	1 = visible to customers, 0 = hidden

3.3.5 staff

Therapists and specialists who perform treatments.

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
staff_id	INT UNSIGNED	Primary key, auto-increment	Unique staff number
full_name	VARCHAR(100)	Required	Staff member name
email	VARCHAR(120)	Required, UNIQUE	Work email
phone	VARCHAR(20)	Required	Contact number
job_title	VARCHAR(80)	Required	For example Senior Facialist
is_active	TINYINT(1)	Default 1	1 = can be booked, 0 = unavailable

3.3.6 staff_services

Link table: which staff member can perform which service (many-to-many).

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
staff_id	INT UNSIGNED	Composite primary key; FK to staff	The therapist
service_id	INT UNSIGNED	Composite primary key; FK to services	The service they can perform

3.3.7 staff_schedules

Weekly working hours for each staff member.

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
schedule_id	INT UNSIGNED	Primary key, auto-increment	Unique schedule row
staff_id	INT UNSIGNED	Foreign key to staff	The therapist
day_of_week	TINYINT UNSIGNED	UNIQUE together with staff_id	1 = Monday … 7 = Sunday
start_time	TIME	Required	Start of working day
end_time	TIME	Required	End of working day

3.3.8 appointments

Every booking made by a customer or administrator.

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
appointment_id	INT UNSIGNED	Primary key, auto-increment	Booking number
customer_id	INT UNSIGNED	Foreign key to customers	Who the booking is for
staff_id	INT UNSIGNED	Foreign key to staff	Therapist performing the service
service_id	INT UNSIGNED	Foreign key to services	Treatment booked
appt_date	DATE	Required	Appointment date
start_time / end_time	TIME	Required	Start and calculated end time
status	ENUM('pending','confirmed','completed','cancelled')	Default pending	Progress of the booking
price_charged	DECIMAL(8,2)	Required	Price at the time of booking (used for reports)
notes	VARCHAR(255)	Optional	Customer notes
created_at	TIMESTAMP	Default current time	When the booking was made
(constraint)		UNIQUE (staff_id, appt_date, start_time)	The database itself refuses double bookings

3.3.9 notifications

Log of every email notification sent to customers.

Field	Data type	Key / constraint	Description
notification_id	INT UNSIGNED	Primary key, auto-increment	Unique message number
customer_id	INT UNSIGNED	Foreign key to customers	Recipient
appointment_id	INT UNSIGNED	Optional	Booking the message is about
subject	VARCHAR(150)	Required	Email subject
message	TEXT	Required	Email body
sent_at	TIMESTAMP	Default current time	When it was sent

4. Customer guide

4.1 Create an account

1. On the home page click **Register** (top right).
2. Enter your **full name**, **email address**, **10-digit phone number** and a **password** of at least 8 characters including a number. The coloured bar under the password shows how strong it is.
3. Re-type the password in **Confirm password** and click **Register**.

If something is wrong, a red message appears under the field straight away, and the server checks everything again when you submit.

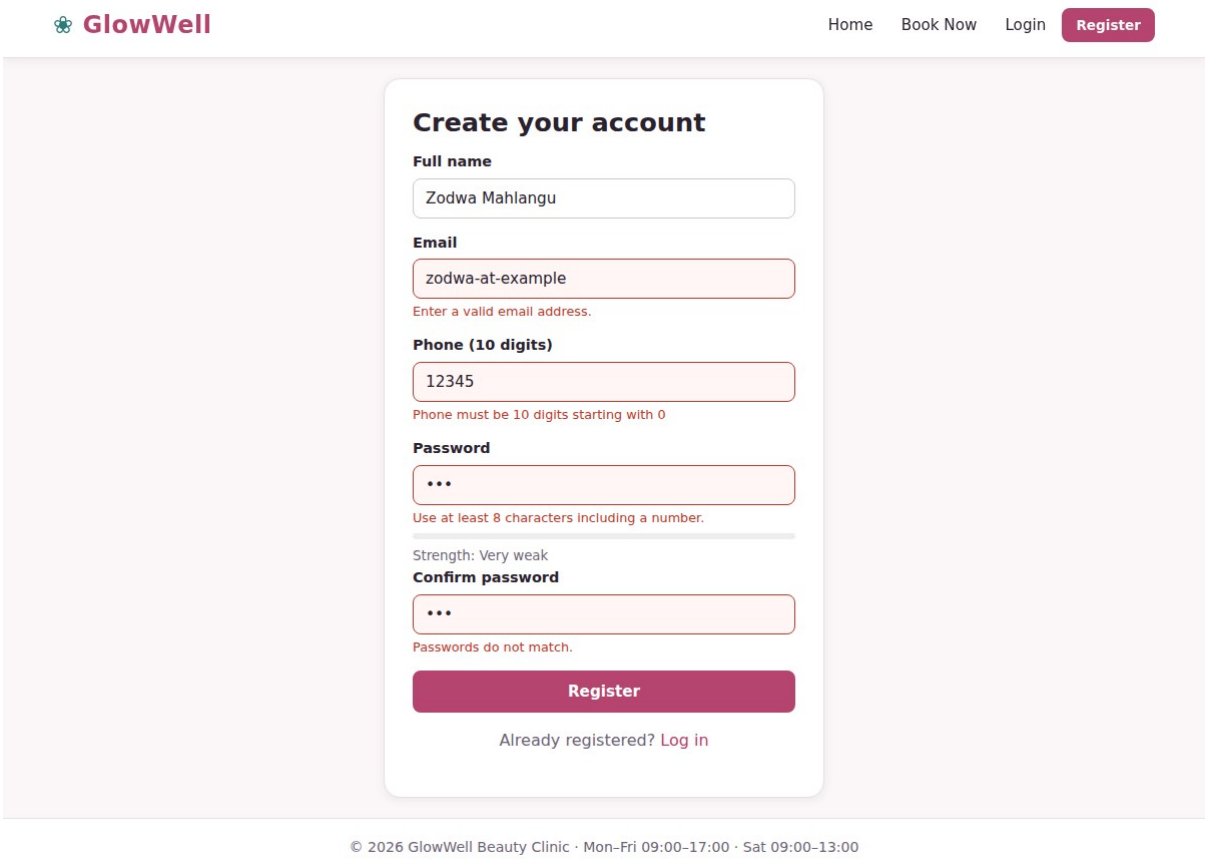


Figure 3: Registration form showing validation messages for invalid input

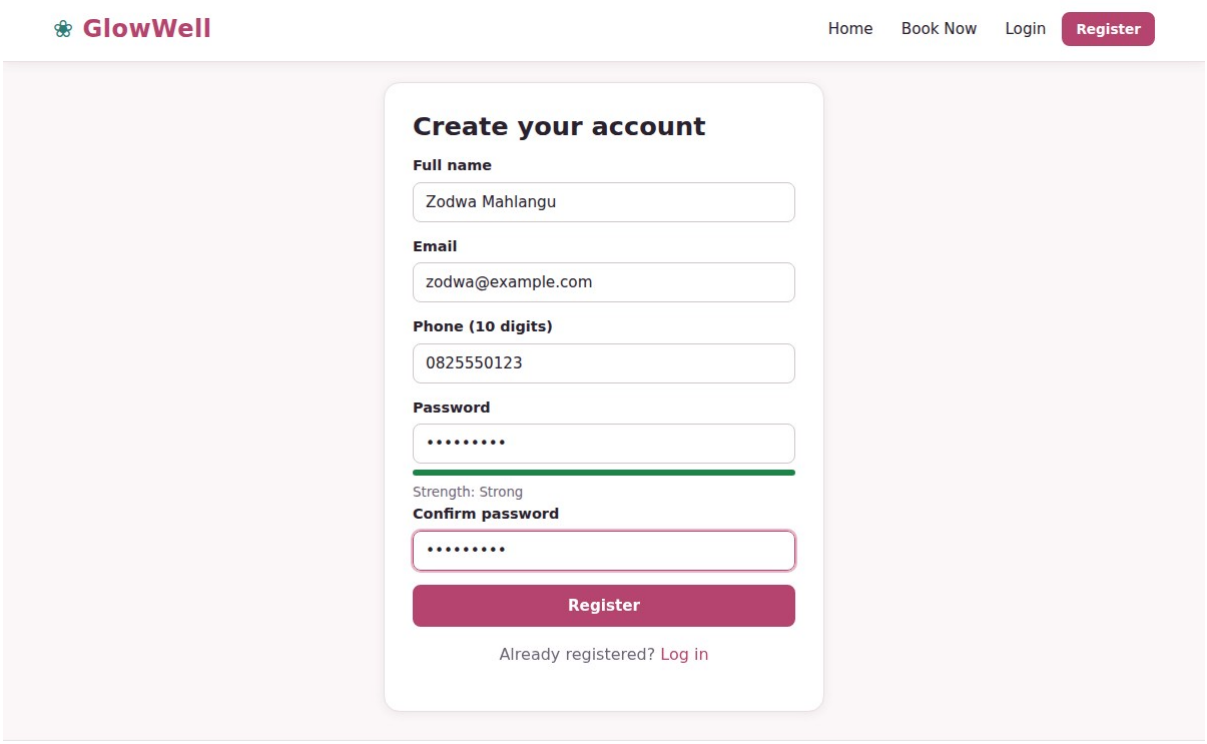


Figure 4: Registration form completed correctly (new customer Zodwa Mahlangu)

After registering you are taken to the login page with a green confirmation message.

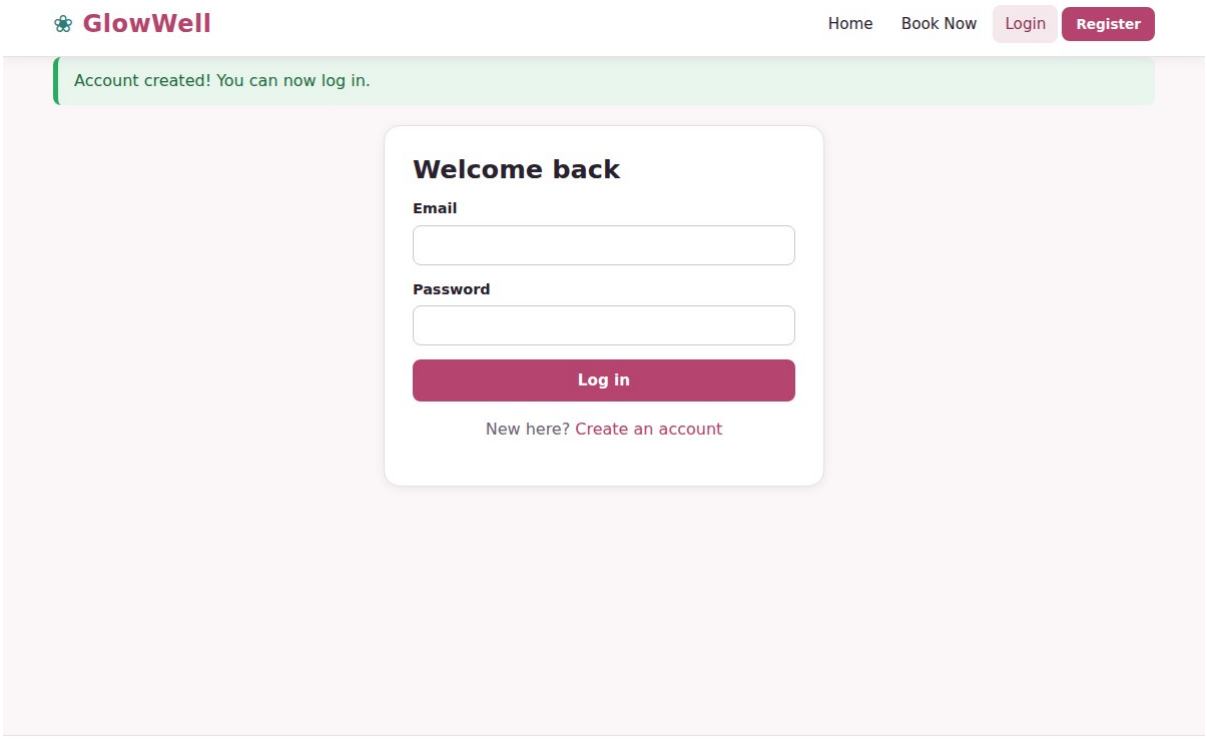


Figure 5: Login page after a successful registration

4.2 Log in

1. Click **Login**, enter your email and password and press **Log in**.
2. Customers land on **My Bookings**; administrators land on the Dashboard.

A wrong email or password shows “Incorrect email or password”. For security the message does not say which one was wrong.

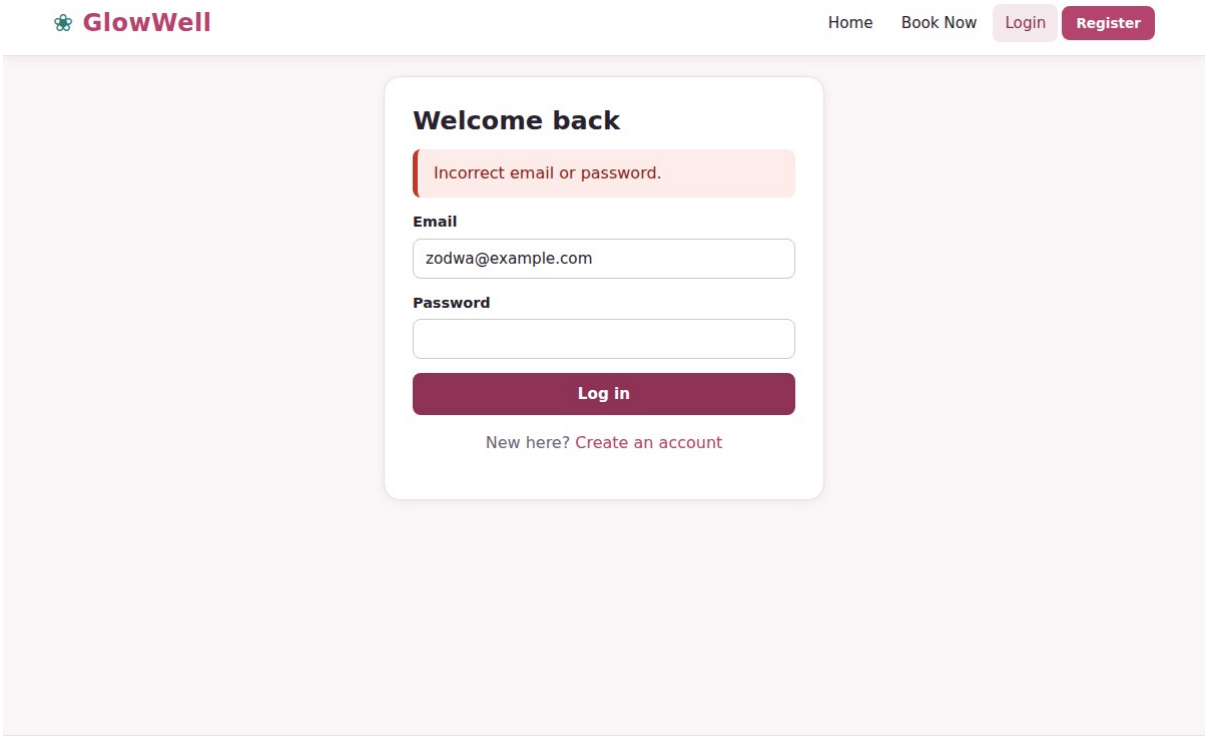


Figure 6: Login error message for incorrect credentials

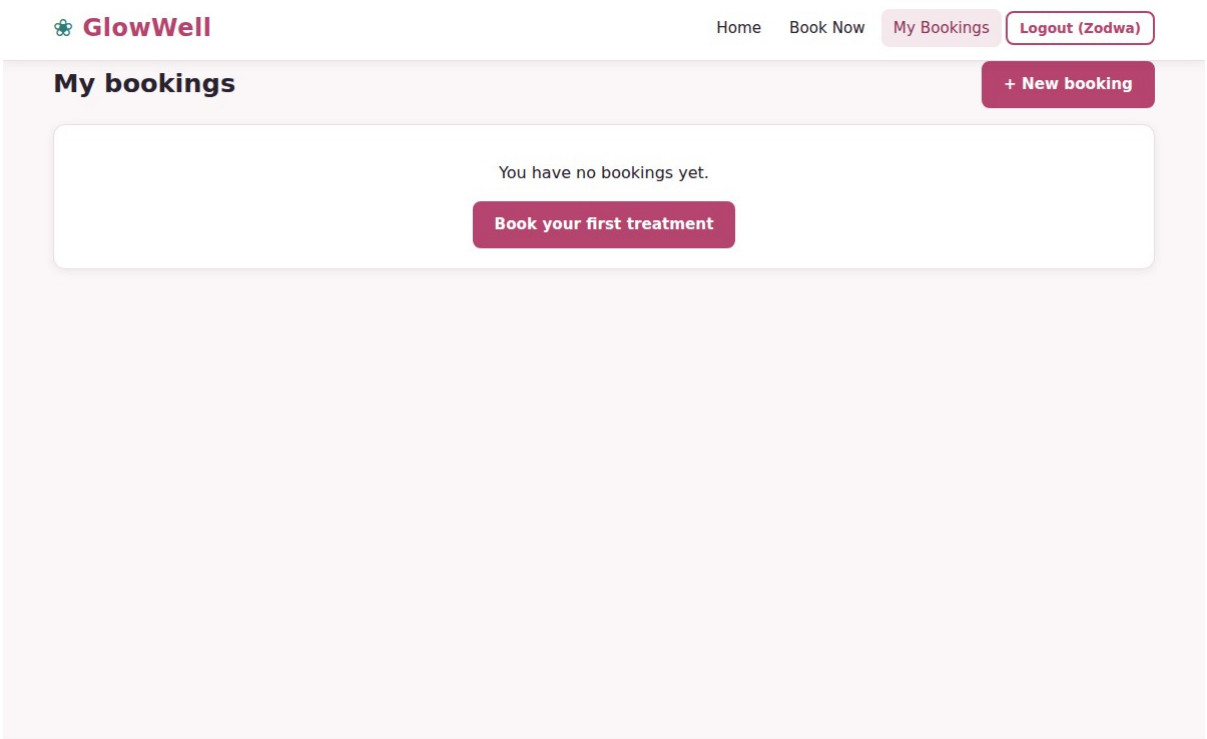


Figure 7: My Bookings for a new customer with no appointments yet

4.3 Book an appointment

1. Click **Book Now** (or **Book this** on a service card on the home page).

2. **Step 1 – Choose a service** from the drop-down list. Duration and price are shown.
3. **Step 2 – Choose a date.** Past dates are not allowed.
4. **Step 3 – Pick a therapist and time.** The page instantly lists every qualified therapist with their free time slots. Slots that are already booked, or outside working hours, do not appear.
5. Click a time slot. It turns green and a summary line confirms your choice.
6. Optionally add notes for the therapist, then click **Confirm booking**.

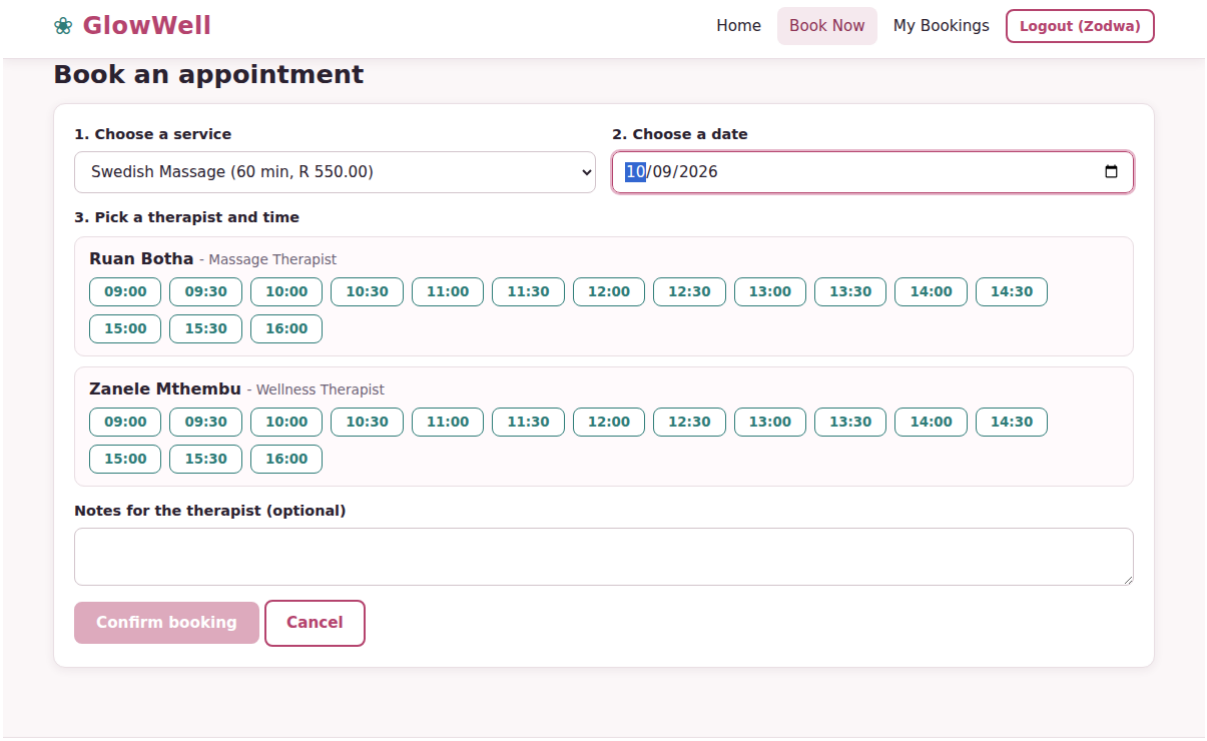


Figure 8: Available therapists and time slots for Swedish Massage on 9 October 2026

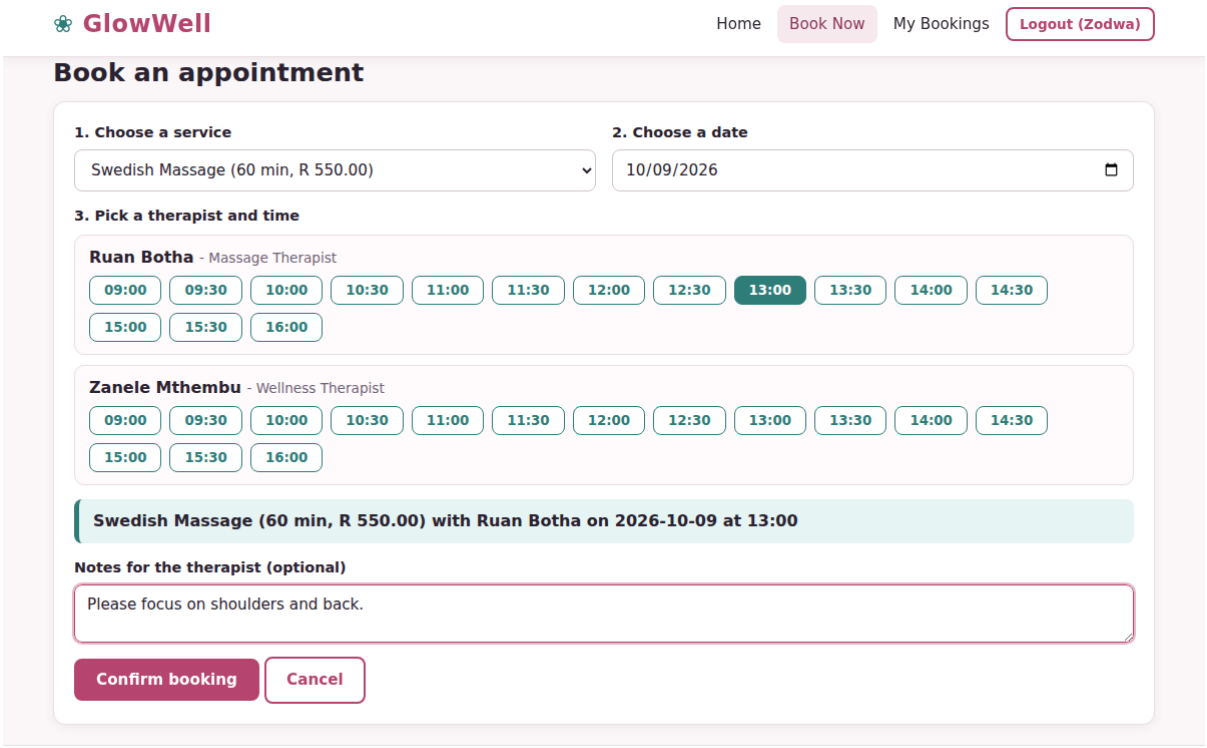


Figure 9: A time slot selected, with the booking summary and notes

You return to **My Bookings** with a confirmation message. The new booking has the status **Pending** until the clinic confirms it, and an email notification is sent.

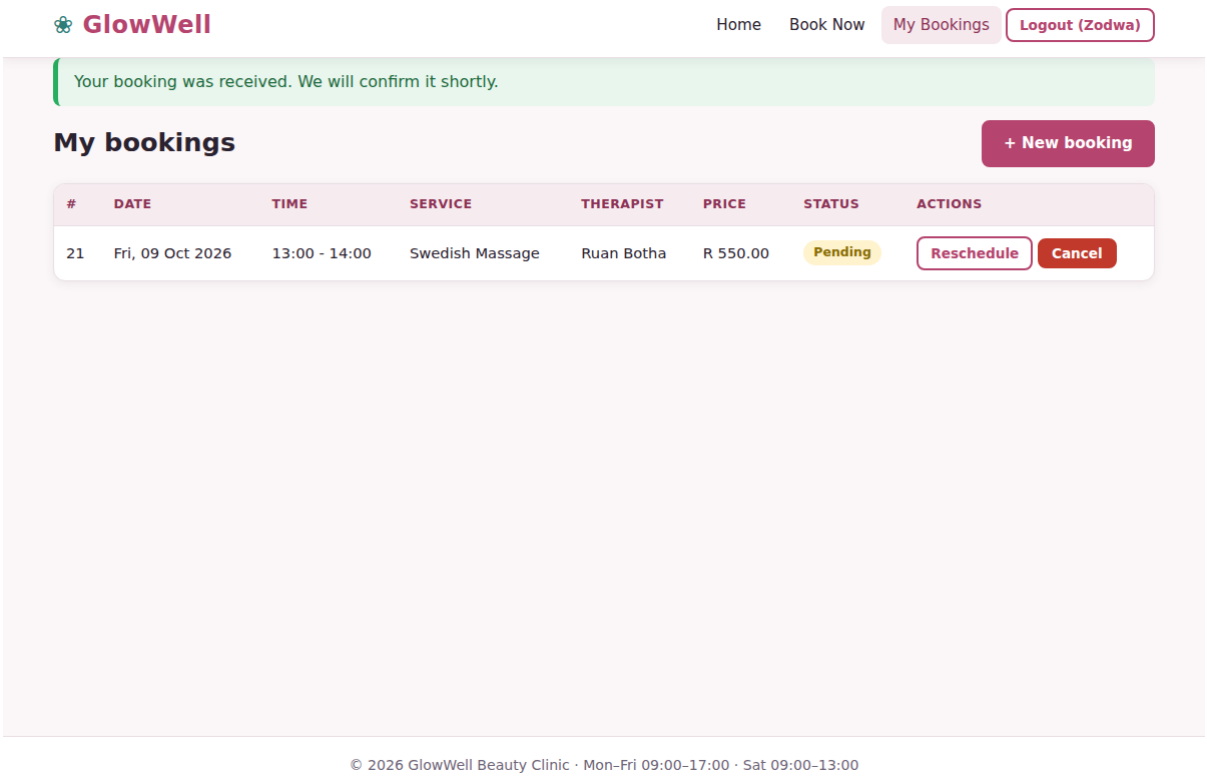


Figure 10: My Bookings showing the new pending appointment

> **Tip:** If someone else books your slot at the same moment, the system tells you and asks you to choose another time – you can never end up double booked.

4.4 Reschedule a booking

1. In **My Bookings** click **Reschedule** next to a pending or confirmed future appointment.
2. The form opens with your current choice already selected. Change the service, date or time slot.
3. Click **Save new time**. The booking returns to Pending for re-confirmation.

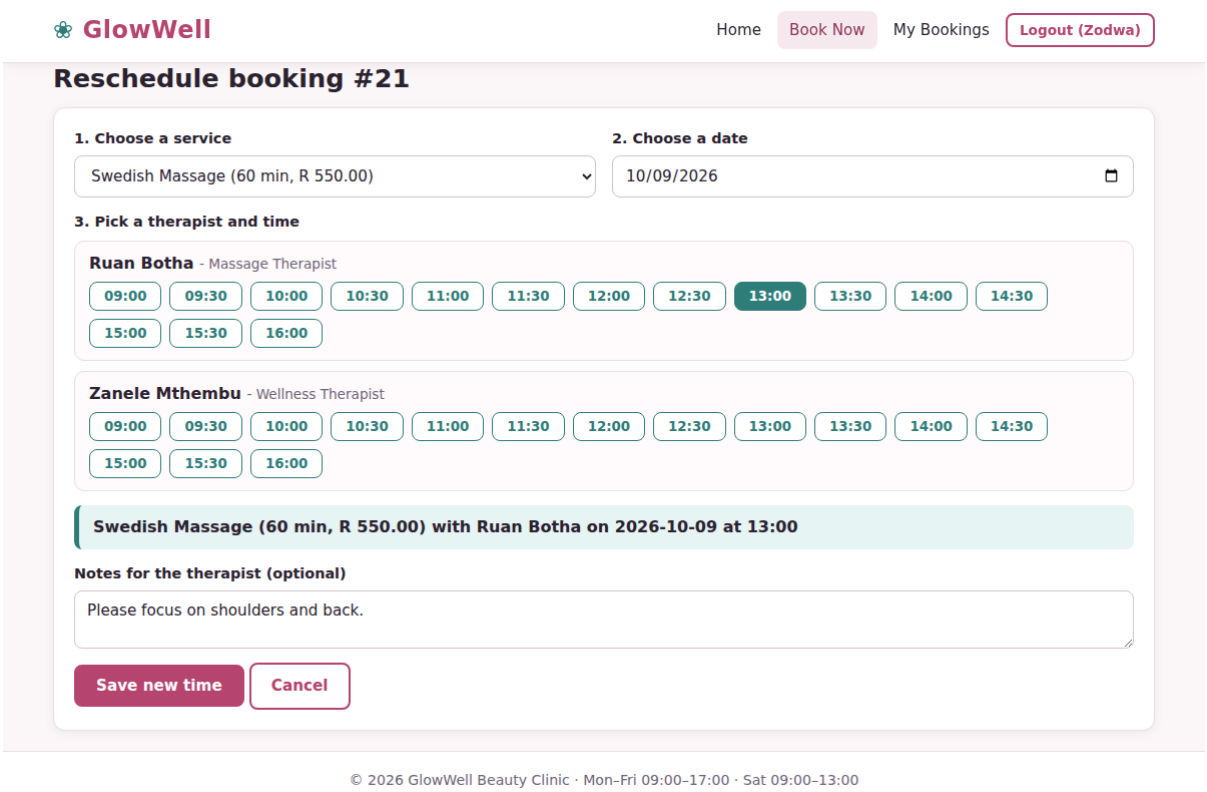


Figure 11: Reschedule screen with the current slot pre-selected

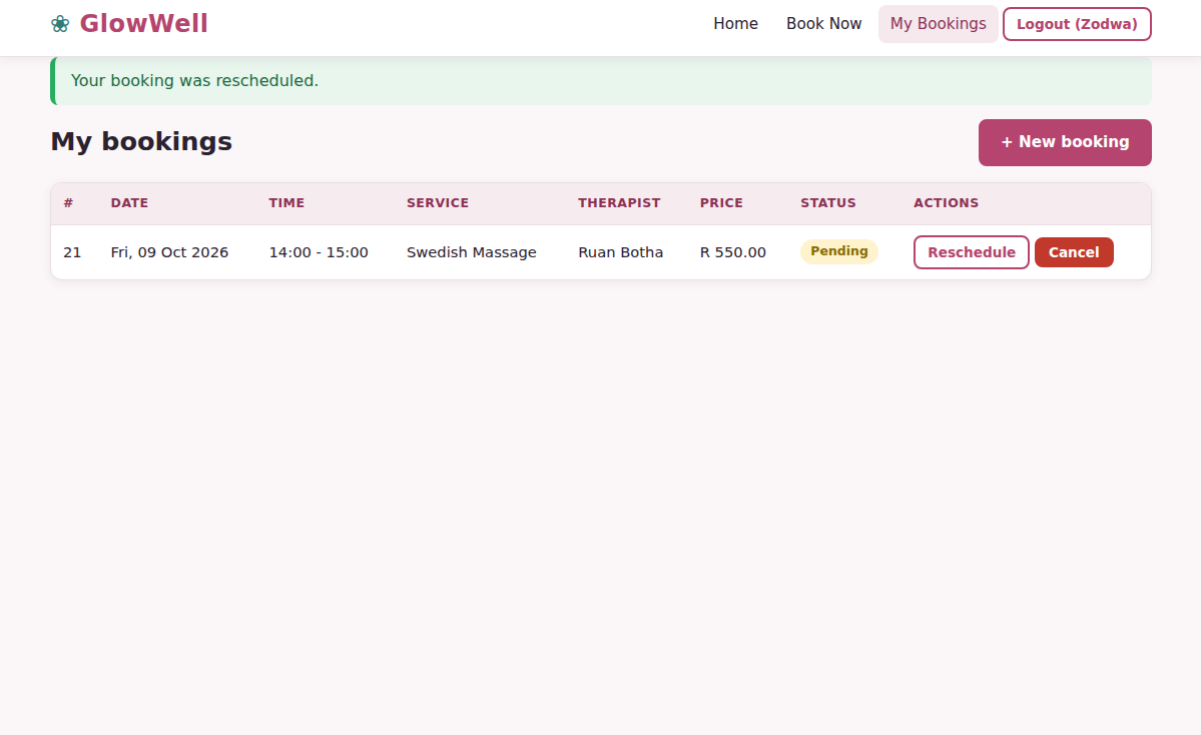


Figure 12: Booking successfully moved to a new time (14:00)

4.5 Cancel a booking

1. Click the red **Cancel** button on the booking.
2. Confirm in the pop-up window. The status changes to **Cancelled** and the time becomes available to others again.

4.6 Log out

Click **Logout** in the top-right corner when you have finished, especially on a shared computer.

5. Administrator guide

Log in with an administrator account. The menu changes to show Dashboard, Bookings, Customers, Staff, Schedules, Services and Reports.

5.1 Dashboard

The dashboard gives a snapshot of the clinic: today's bookings, bookings waiting for approval, total customers, active staff and revenue for the current month. A chart shows the number of bookings for the next seven days, and the table lists the next appointments. The buttons on the right are shortcuts to common tasks.

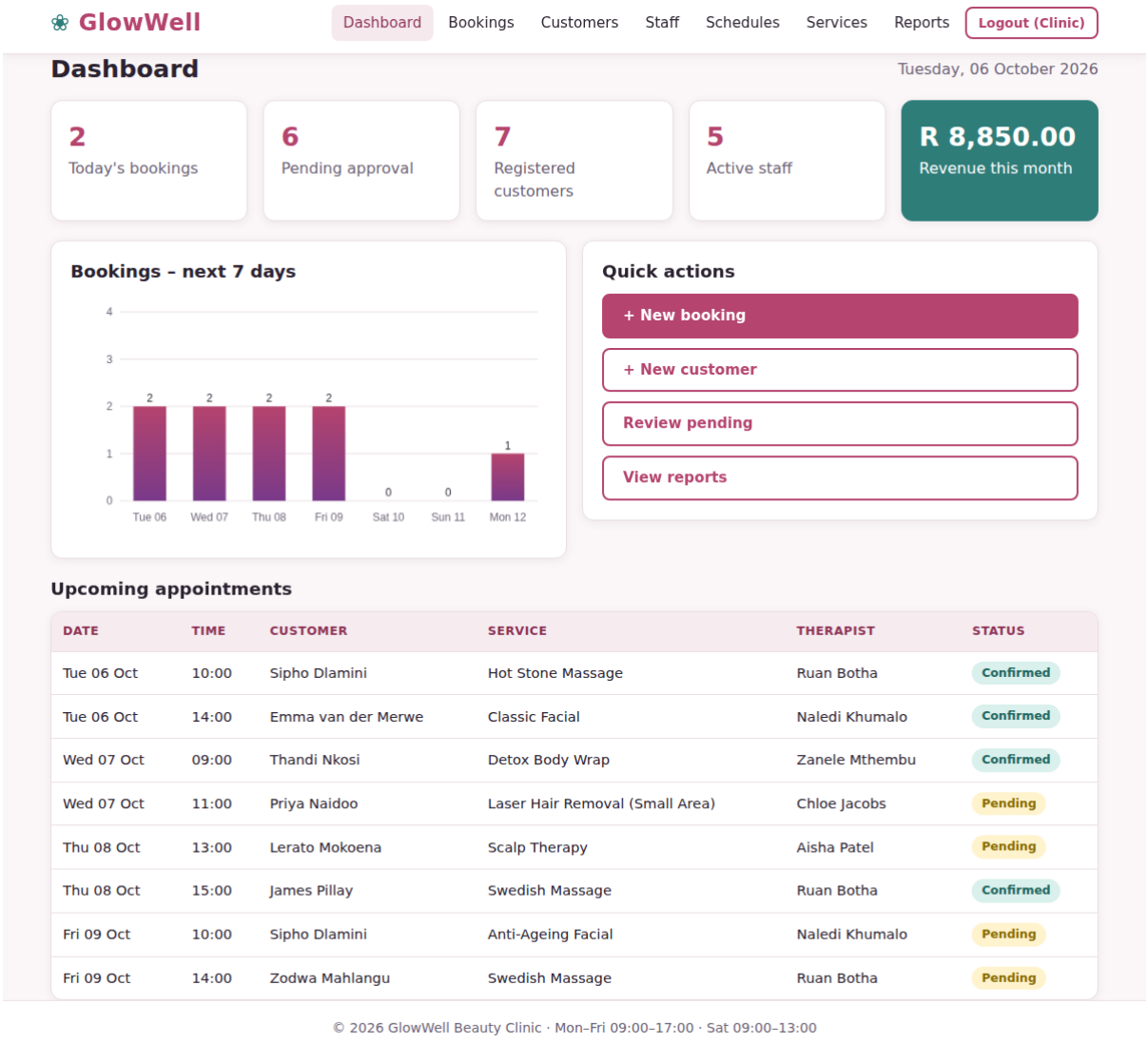


Figure 13: Administrator dashboard

5.2 Manage bookings

1. Click **Bookings** to see every appointment, newest first.
2. Use the search box, **status** filter and **From/To** dates, then click **Filter**. Click **Reset** to clear them.
3. To approve or change a booking, use the **status drop-down** in its row. The change saves immediately and the customer receives an email.

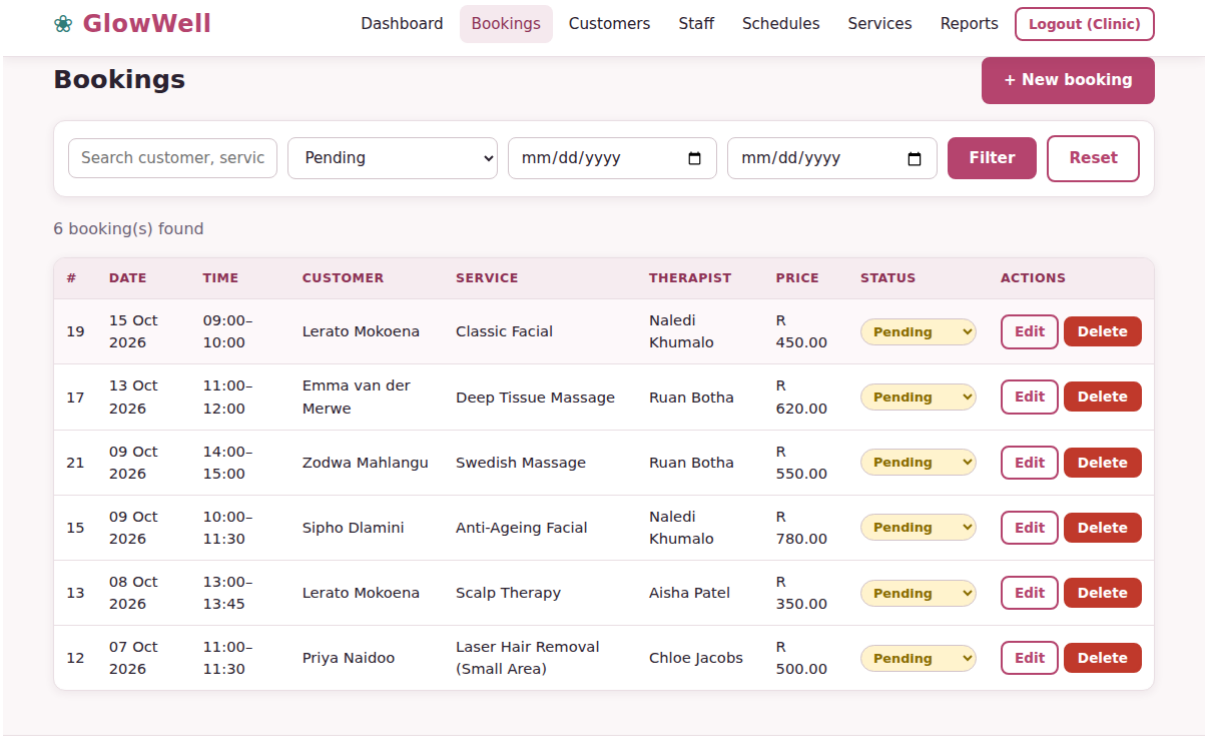


Figure 14: Bookings filtered to show only pending appointments

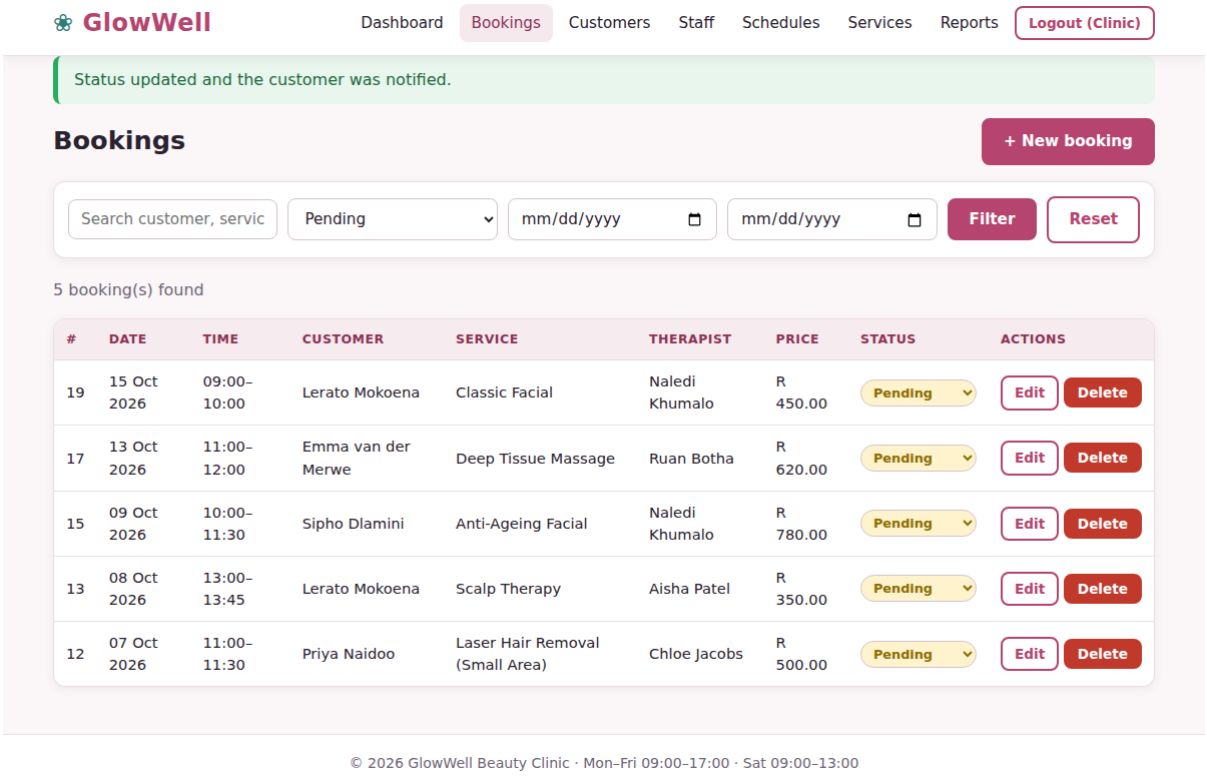


Figure 15: Status of Zodwa Mahlangu's booking changed to Confirmed

Create a booking for a customer (for example a phone or walk-in booking)

1. Click **+ New booking**.
2. Select the **customer**, **status**, **service** and **date**.
3. Click an available time slot under the therapist, then click **Create booking**.

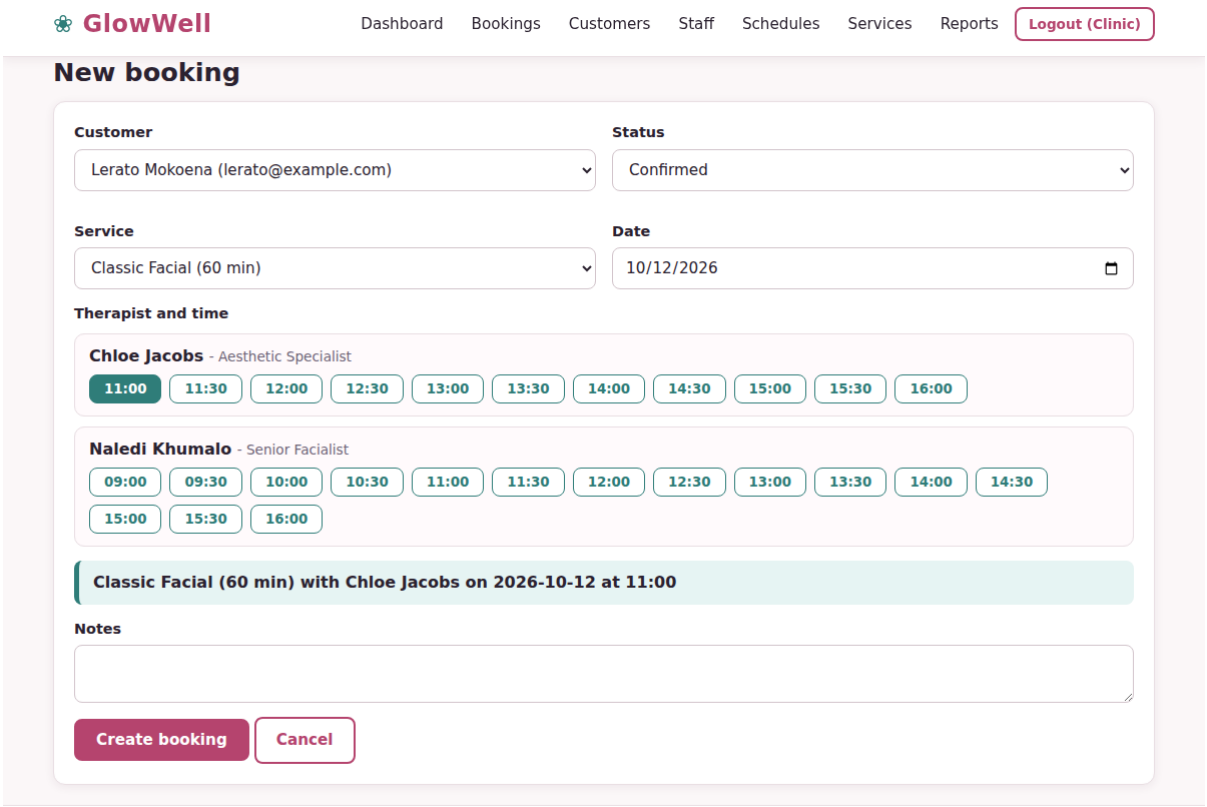


Figure 16: Creating a booking for the walk-in customer Lerato Mokoena

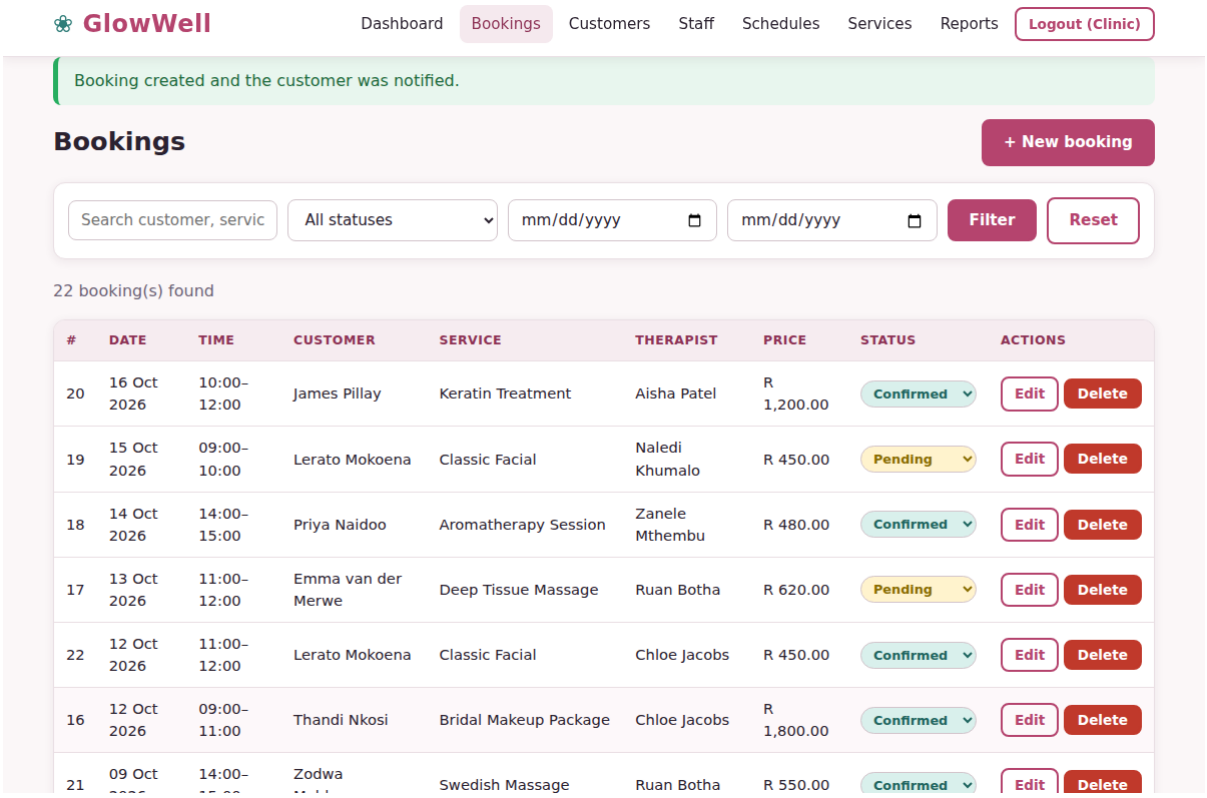


Figure 17: Booking created and the customer notified

Use **Edit** on any row to change a booking and **Delete** to remove one permanently (you are asked to confirm first). To simply cancel a booking while keeping the record, set its status to Cancelled.

5.3 Manage customers

1. Click **Customers** to see all clients with their number of bookings and total spend.
2. Search by name, email or phone number.
3. Click **+ Add customer**, complete the form and click **Save customer**. Use this for walk-in clients who have no online account.
4. Use **Edit** to update details or **Delete** to remove a customer together with their bookings.

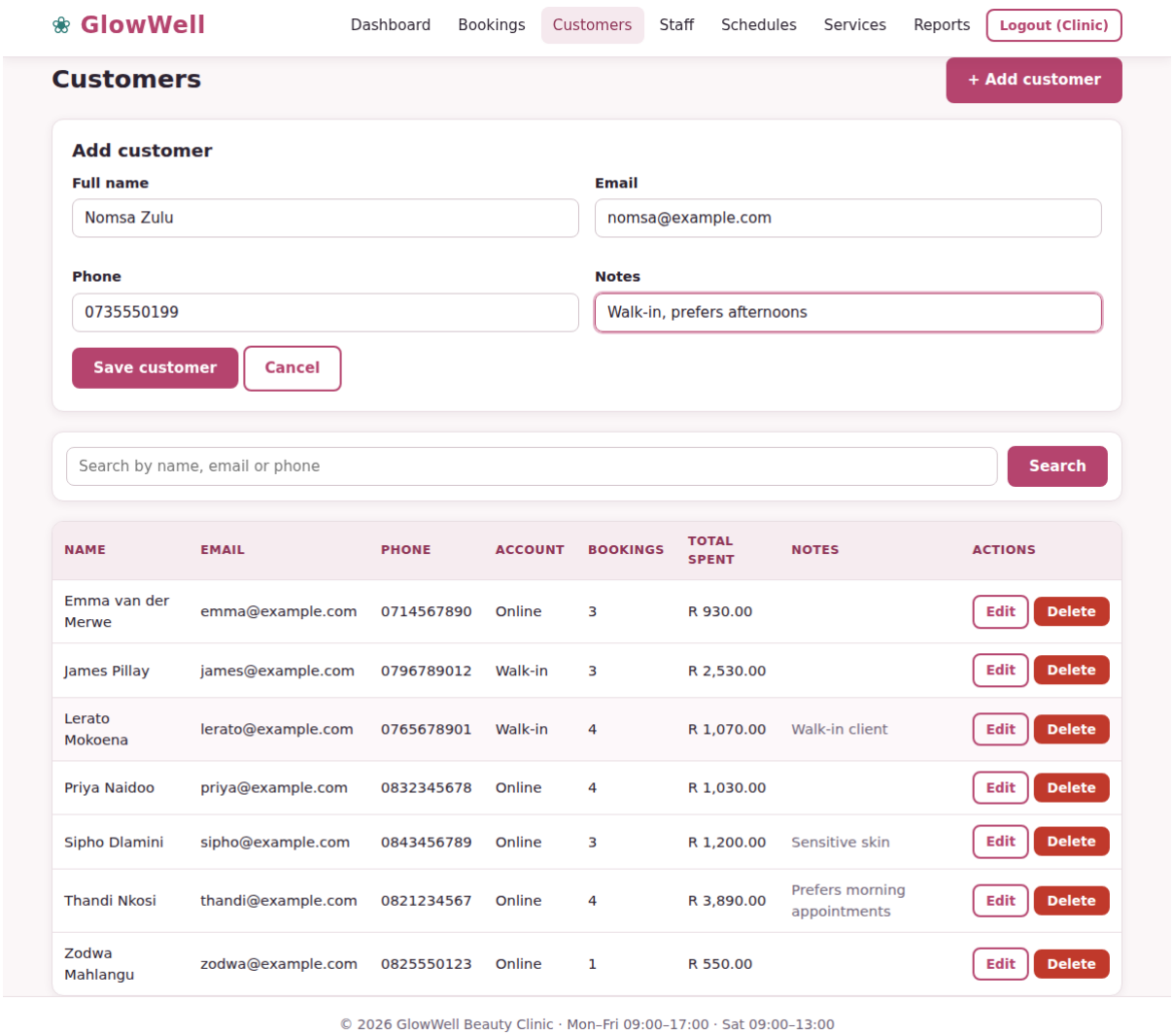


Figure 18: Adding a new walk-in customer

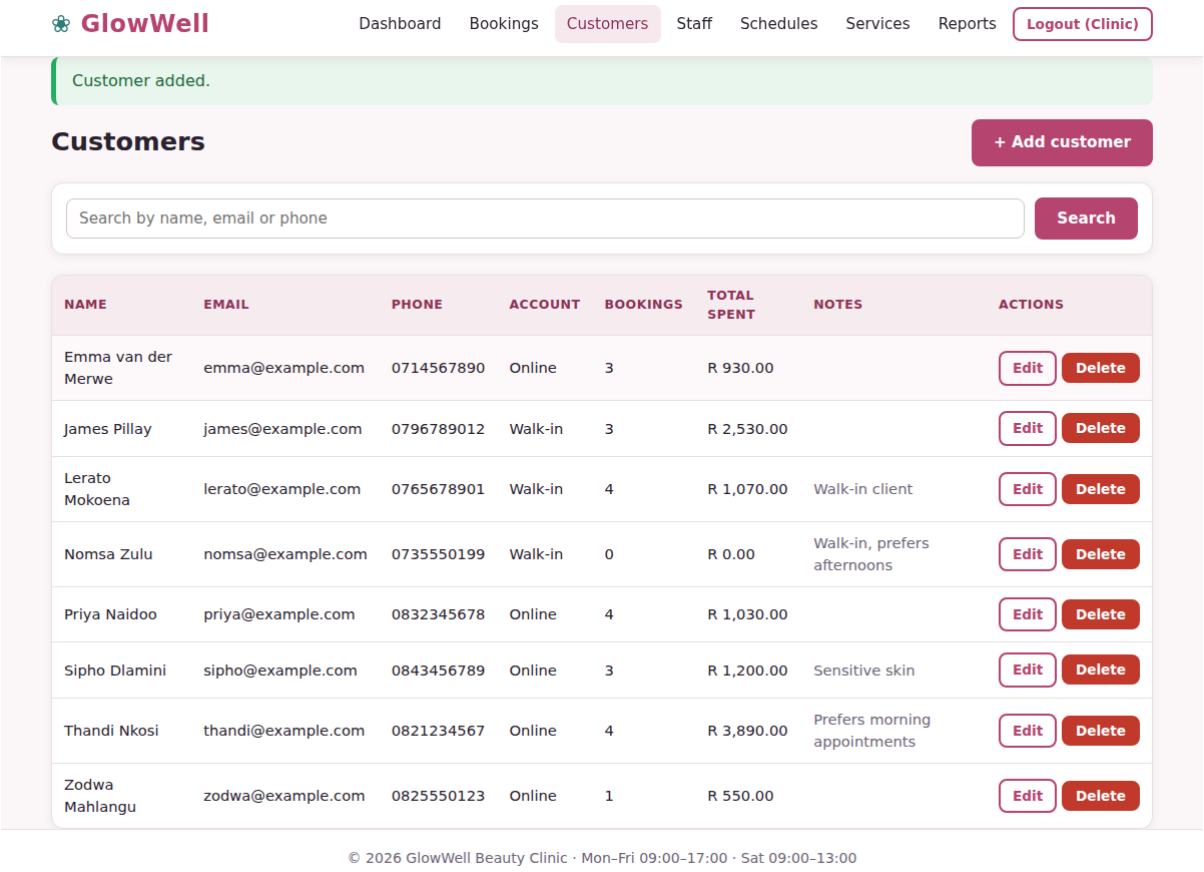


Figure 19: Customer list after the new customer was added

5.4 Manage staff

1. Click **Staff**, then **+ Add staff member** (or **Edit** on an existing person).
2. Enter name, job title, email and phone.
3. Tick every **service** this person can perform. Customers will only see this therapist for those services.
4. Untick **Active** to stop a person being booked without deleting their history. Click **Save staff member**.

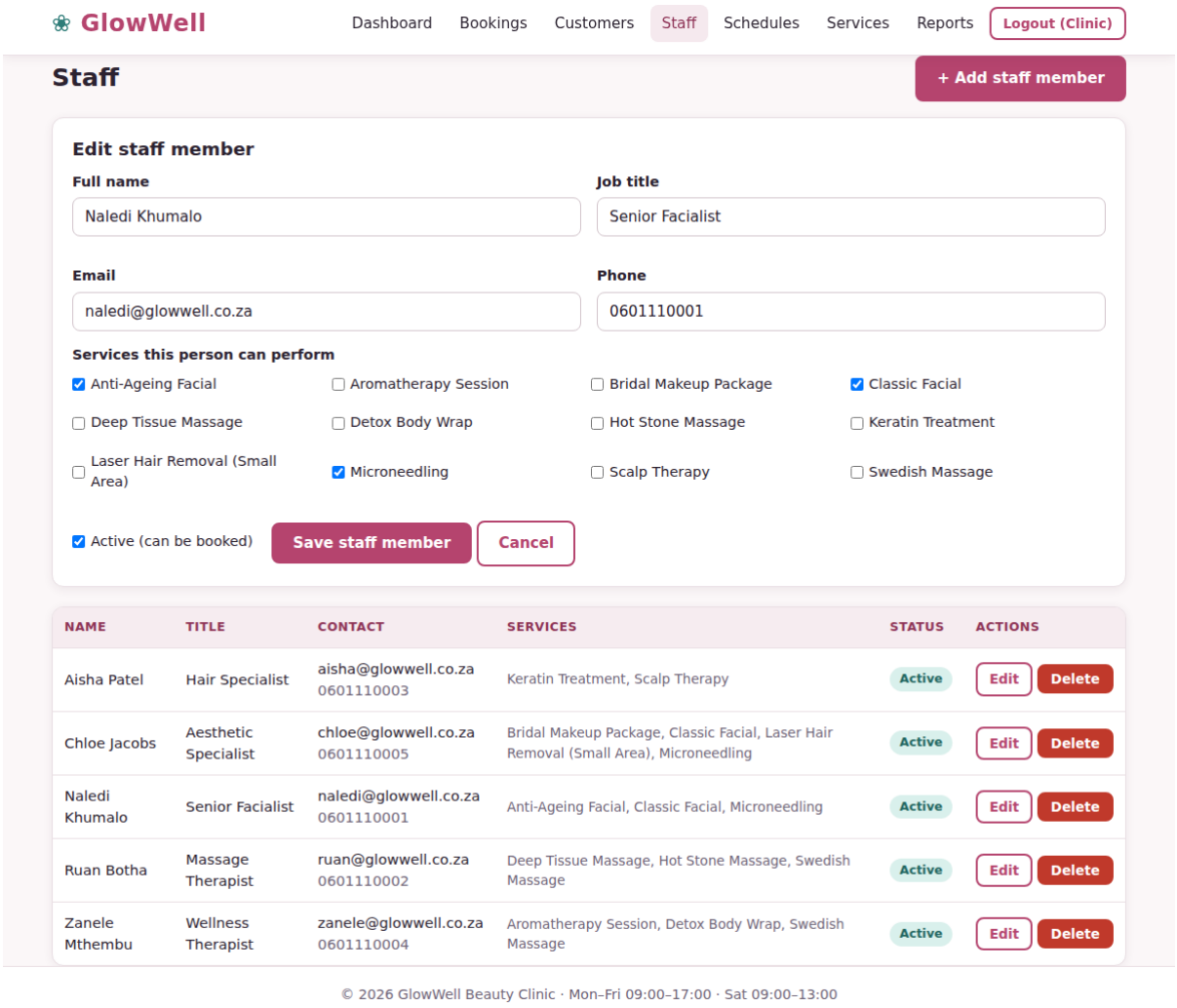


Figure 20: Editing a staff member and the services they perform

> **Tip:** A staff member who already has bookings cannot be deleted. Mark them inactive instead.

5.5 Staff schedules

1. Click **Schedules**. Each therapist has a weekly panel.
2. Tick the days they work and set the start and end time for each day.
3. Click **Save schedule**. Customers can only book inside these hours.

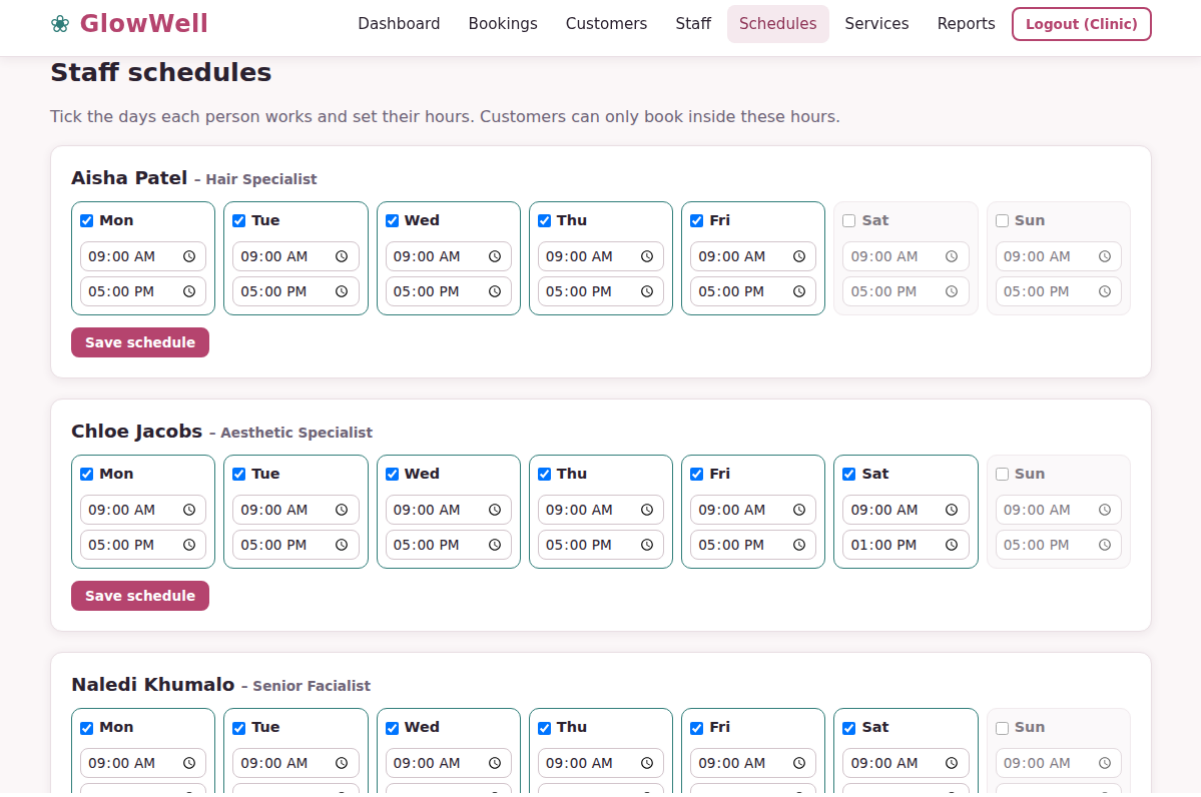


Figure 21: Weekly schedule editor for each therapist

5.6 Manage services

1. Click **Services** to see the price list.
2. Click **+ Add service** or **Edit**. Choose a category, name, duration (15–240 minutes) and price.
3. Untick **Active** to hide a service from customers. Click **Save service**.

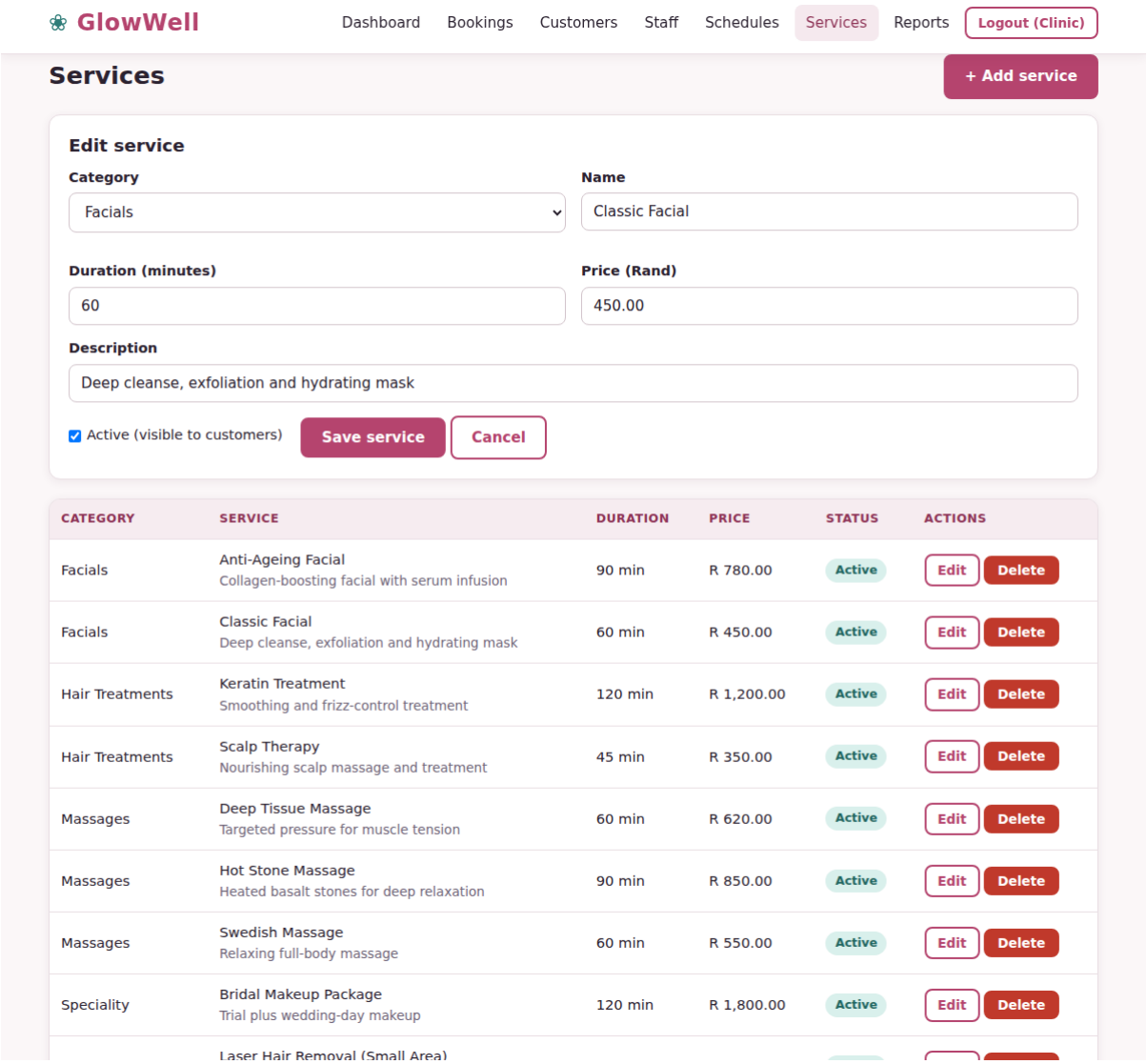


Figure 22: Editing a service

5.7 Reports

1. Click **Reports** and choose a **From** and **To** date, then click **Generate report**.
2. Review total bookings, revenue and average booking value, the revenue-by-category chart and the tables for therapists, top services and top customers.
3. Click **Print** for a paper copy or **Export CSV** to open the detailed data in Excel.

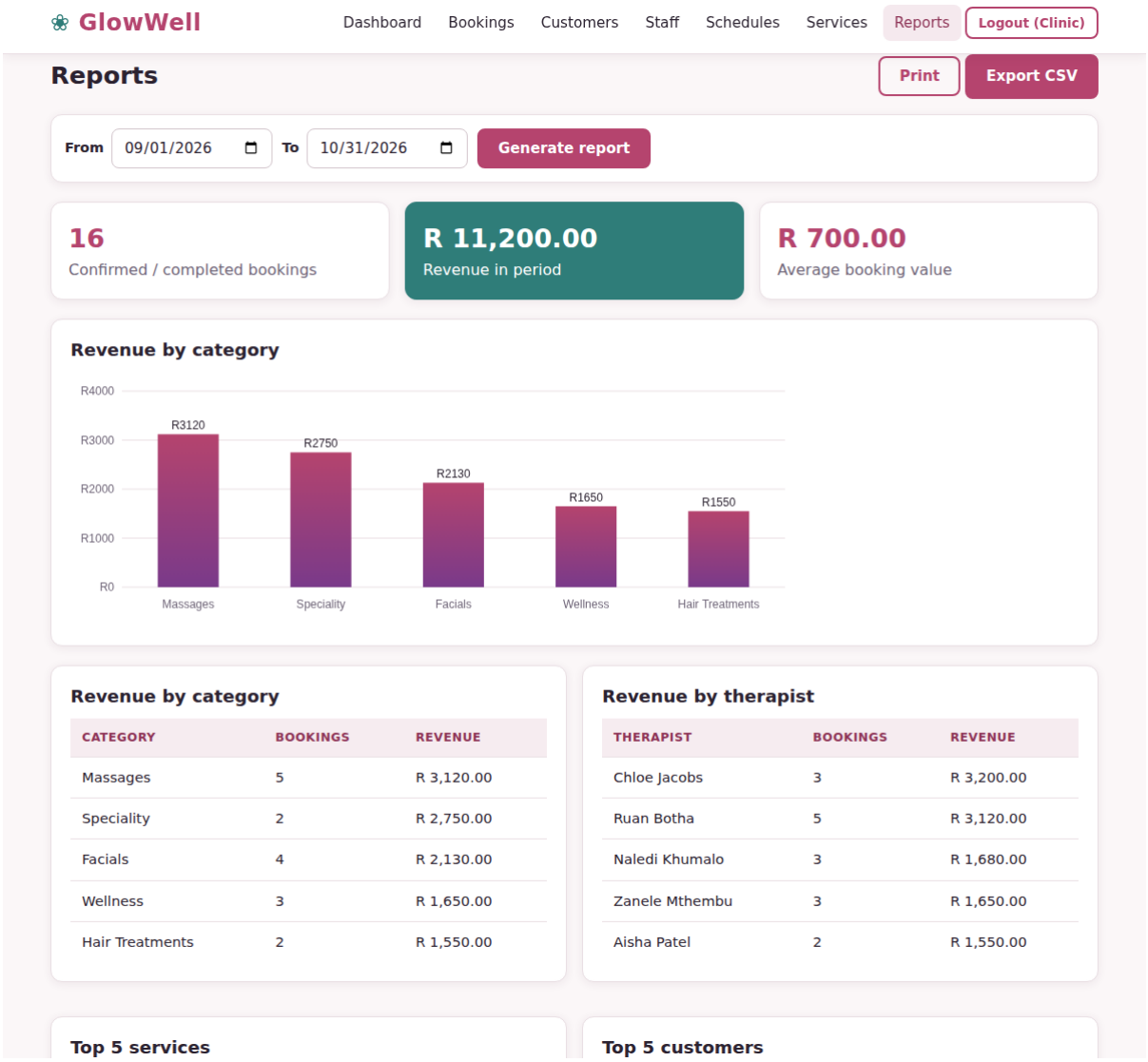


Figure 23: Revenue and booking report for September–October 2026

6. Security and data protection

- **Hashed passwords** – passwords are never stored or shown in readable form.
- **Role-based access** – customers cannot open admin pages, and each customer only sees their own bookings.
- **Validated input** – every form is checked in the browser for instant feedback and again on the server before anything is saved.
- **Protected database access** – all database requests use prepared statements, which blocks SQL injection.
- **Form protection** – secure tokens on every form prevent forged requests, and all displayed text is escaped.
- **Safe sessions** – a new session is issued at login and destroyed at logout.

7. Messages and troubleshooting

Message or problem	What it means	What to do
Please log in to continue	You opened a page that needs an account	Log in, or register first
Incorrect email or password	Details do not match an account	Re-type carefully; passwords are case-sensitive
Phone number must be 10 digits starting with 0	Phone format is wrong	Enter for example 0821234567
An account with that email already exists	Email is already registered	Log in instead
You cannot book a date in the past	The chosen date has passed	Choose today or a later date
Fully booked or closed on this date	No therapist has a free slot	Try another day
That time slot has just been taken	Another booking was made first	Choose a different slot
Staff member has bookings and cannot be deleted	Deleting would lose booking history	Mark the person inactive instead
Database connection failed	MySQL is off or login details are wrong	Start MySQL and check config/db.php

For further help contact the clinic reception during opening hours: Monday to Friday 09:00–17:00 and Saturday 09:00–13:00.